

Zijin (Jean) Zhang

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ACADEMIC POSITION	Boston College, Carroll School of Management Assistant Professor of Business Analytics	2025 - Present
EDUCATION	University of Michigan, Ross School of Business Ph.D. in Technology & Operations	2019 - 2025
	Nanjing University B.S. in Mathematics and Statistics	2014 - 2018
	University of Wisconsin-Madison Exchange Program	2017
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Data-Centric AI ◊ Data-Driven Optimization ◊ Machine Learning Retail Analytics ◊ Public-Sector Operations	
PUBLICATIONS	[1] Online Decisions with (Biased) Offline Data, with Hyun-Soo Ahn and Mengzhenyu Zhang. Forthcoming at <i>Operations Research</i> [link]	
WORKING PAPERS	[2] More Data or Better Data? Impact of Costly Data Collection on the Newsvendor Problem, with Hyun-Soo Ahn and Lennart Baardman. Major revision at <i>Management Science</i> [link]	
	[3] Rethinking College Admissions: Can Test-Optional Policies Even the Playing Field? with Yao Cui and Stefanus Jasin. Major revision at <i>Management Science</i> [link] • Finalist, DSI Doctoral Research Showcase Award 2025	
	[4] Inventory Ordering and Product Ranking for Online Curation Retailers, with Hyun-Soo Ahn and Lennart Baardman. Major revision at <i>Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i> [link] • Selected for presentation at MSOM SIG spotlight 2024	
	[5] Too Big to Wait? Capacity Scaling under Congestion Signals, with Yang Li, Daniel Zhuoyu Long, Rowan Wang, and Zhenkun Xu. Revision at <i>Production and Operations Management</i> [link]	
	[6] Creators vs. GenAI: Optimizing Data Sharing and Compensation in Content Markets, with Joonho Bae. [link] • Finalist, INFORMS Service Science Cluster Best Paper 2026	
	[7] Non-Adaptive Query Optimization for Multi-LLM Classification: Hardness and Approximation, with Arlen Dean, Stefanus Jasin, and Yuqing Liu. [link]	
	[8] Rethinking Visibility: The Distribution of Visible and Invisible Public Goods Beyond Democracies, with Jingyang Rui and Weikun Yang. [link] • Formerly titled “ <i>Beyond the Promise: Distributional Discordance in China’s Pandemic Control</i> ” • Michigan Ross China Research Award 2023 • Selected for presentation at APSA Conference 2024 • Selected for Rising Star session at CES North America Conference 2025	

TEACHING

Boston College, Carroll School of Management**Instructor, BBA Core**

- BZAN 1021: Operations Management

2026 - Present

University of Michigan, Ross School of Business**Instructor, BBA Core**

- TO 313: Operations Management

2021

Teaching Assistant, EMBA

- EMBA 610: Managerial Big Data Analytics
- EMBA Quantitative Workshop
- EMBA 603: Business Analytics and Statistics for Executives
- Online Executive Education: Value Driven Thinking

2022, 2024, 2025

2021, 2024

2020, 2023

2022

Teaching Assistant, MBA and PhD

- MBA Analytics Primer Workshop
- TO 550: Introduction to Data Programming
- TO 718: Data Analytics
- TO 593: Operations Management
- TO 899: Inventory Theory (PhD core)
- TO 534: Introduction to Operations
- TO 421: Logistics
- TO 605: Manufacturing and Supply Operations
- TO 618: Applied Business Analytics and Decisions

2024

2024

2023

2023

2022

2022

2021

2019, 2020

2020

PROFESSIONAL
EXPERIENCE**Oracle**

Data Scientist Intern (retail optimization)

2022

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Research Fellow

2019

CITIC

Risk Analyst Intern

2015

HONORS &
AWARDS

Finalist, INFORMS Service Science Cluster Best Paper

2026

Finalist, DSI Doctoral Research Showcase Award

2025

Rackham Graduate Fellowship

2024 - 2025

Spivey Hall Fellowship

2023 - 2024

Thomas William Leabo Fellowship

2022 - 2023

Michigan Ross Ph.D. Fellowship

2019 - 2024

Michigan Ross China Research Award

2023

Doctoral Research Grant, University of Michigan

2022 - 2024

Second place, National Citi Cup Financial Innovation Contest

2016

INVITED TALKS

“Non-Adaptive Query Optimization for Multi-LLM Classification: Hardness and Approximation”

- INFORMS 2026

“More Data or Better Data? Impact of Costly Data Collection on the Newsvendor Problem”

- INFORMS 2023, MSSISS 2024, MSOM 2024, ISMP 2024, TTIC 2024, INFORMS 2024, RMP 2025
- Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Center for Transportation & Logistics, 2026 (scheduled)

“Online Decisions with (Biased) Offline Data”

- INFORMS 2025
- University of Toronto, Rotman School of Management (Young Scholar Seminar), 2026

“Rethinking College Admissions: Can Test-Optional Policy Even the Playing Field?”

- DSI 2025 (Award Session), INFORMS MIF Poster Competition 2025, MSOM 2026, INFORMS 2026

“Creators vs. GenAI: Optimize Data Sharing and Compensation in Content Markets”

- RMP 2025, AIML 2025, INFORMS 2026 (Award Session)

“Inventory Ordering and Product Ranking for Online Curation Retailers”

- INFORMS 2021, INFORMS 2022, MSOM 2023, MSOM SIG 2024
- Nanjing University, School of Management and Engineering, 2023

“Rethinking Visibility: The Distribution of Visible and Invisible Public Goods Beyond Democracies”

- MSSISS 2024, APSA 2024, IWCP 2024, CESNA 2025, MPSA 2025

SERVICES

Reviewer for *Operations Research, Management Science, Manufacturing & Service Operations Management, Production and Operations Management*

Session chair for INFORMS 2024, INFORMS 2026

Judge for MSOM SIG 2025, MSOM SIG 2026, MSOM 2026

Invited speaker at INFORMS Minority Issues Panel 2024, Michigan Ross Teaching Panel 2022, Michigan Ross PhD Forum 2022

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming: C++, Python, Pascal, Matlab, R, Stata, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Fun: backpacker, squash player, tennis learner, rock climber, and nature explorer;

I compete for Cambridge Athletic Club Women’s Squash Team in the Greater Boston Area

Last updated in August 2026